BRONWEN RAIKES

GAME DESIGNER | VISUAL & NARRATIVE DESIGNER

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Game designer and visual artist with two years of independent game development experience, with a strong focus on character design, concept art, environments and visual storytelling. Develops characters from initial ideas and sketches through visual refinement, using appearance, expression and design details to communicate personality and narrative. Combines hands-on artistic work and creative direction with experience in branching narratives, gameplay systems, player psychology and collaborative development. Holds a Distinction in Art & Design and has delivered commissioned artwork and exhibited original work.

CORE STRENGTHS

- Character design & Concept art
- Narrative design & branching dialogue
- Design documentation & iterative refinement
- Research & interpretation
- Storyboarding & visual storytelling
- Systems design & critical reasoning
- Unity familiarity & C# (currently learning)
- World building & player psychology

SELECTED GAME DESIGN PROJECTS

SCAMPHONY — Lead Designer & Narrative Designer

Independent game development | Pixel Raikes

Designed a three-phase gameplay structure in which mechanics, interface and narrative tone evolve alongside the protagonist's psychological decline.

Built a dual-layer suspicion system (local and global), connecting player decisions to escalating difficulty and consequences.

Created a deception-based core loop centred on interpreting dialogue cues, identifying hidden traits and managing risk.

Developed interconnected customer archetypes, progression, upgrades, narrative-integrated minigames and branching outcomes.

Documented interconnected systems, UX and narrative structure; evaluated clarity, consistency and player interpretation through iteration and collaborative feedback.

Independent RPG Project — Lead Designer & Narrative Designer

Independent game development

Developed branching dialogue structures and early choice-tree frameworks for character-driven storytelling.

Created worldbuilding concepts drawing on Welsh folklore and cultural research, including an experimental in-world language.

Researched environmental storytelling, movement and animation principles; evaluated interaction, scene composition and production constraints.

Assessed project feasibility and scope, helping inform a pivot towards a more focused development project.

PROFESSIONAL & CREATIVE EXPERIENCE

Game Designer & Co-Founder — Pixel Raikes

October 2024 – Present

- Lead character and environment design from initial concepts and sketches through visual development and refinement, creating expressive designs that communicate personality, atmosphere and narrative.

- Develop and direct the visual identity of characters and environments, ensuring artistic consistency and cohesion with the wider game world.

- Design interconnected gameplay mechanics, narrative structures and interactive experiences, integrating visual storytelling with player psychology and experience.

- Collaborate with a developer to translate creative concepts into practical requirements, refining designs through research, feedback and iteration.

Freelance Artist — Self-employed

2022 – 2023

Created commissioned artwork to detailed client briefs, applying composition, artistic judgement and close visual scrutiny to refine work through feedback.

Managed client communication, schedules and payment arrangements independently.

Sold and exhibited original work online and at public events, receiving award recognition and contributing to charitable fundraising.

Sales Assistant — Wasons DIY, Penarth

April 2021 – Present

Trusted with till reconciliation, cash handling and opening/closing procedures requiring accuracy and accountability.

Identified discrepancies and resolved complex customer issues through careful assessment and independent problem-solving.

Recognised and appropriately escalated fraud and safeguarding risks while maintaining professional confidentiality.

EDUCATION

Foundation Diploma in Art & Design — Distinction

Cardiff and Vale College | 2021 – 2022

A Levels — Art, Mathematics and Chemistry

St Cyres Comprehensive | 2019 – 2021

TECHNICAL FAMILIARITY

Unity; interactive narrative and dialogue systems; foundational understanding of programming concepts.